

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
Comparison of the AMD
Radeon RX 5500 XT vs
NVIDIA GTX 1650 Super,
DJI Mavic Mini Tear-down,
tips and tricks for Tab-
leau, Netflix and Android
developer options this
month...



US Navy bans TikTok

As per a bulletin issued by the US Navy towards the end of December 2019, all government-issued devices with the TikTok app installed would be blocked from the Navy Marine Corps Intranet as the app represented a cybersecurity threat.

<https://dgit.in/TikTokTaTa>

WHAT'S NEW

Avast sold data of 400 million of their users

Avast was exposed selling user data in a blog post written by Wladimir Palant, the creator of Adblock Plus. Apparently Avast's web browser extensions on Google Chrome, Firefox and Opera were found to be harvesting browsing behaviour of their users which was then being reportedly anonymised by an Avast owned company before being sold as consumer insights. Firefox and Opera were quick to take down the extensions from their web stores whereas Google Chrome has yet to do so even at the time of writing this. Avast has been



doing so since at least 2013 and as per certain estimates, it has sold data of approximately 400 million of its users. Avast reportedly only makes 5% of their overall revenue via sales of

their users' data. As per Jumpshot, the website through which the data is sold, the collected data is an "incredibly detailed clickstream data from 100 million global online shoppers and 20 million global app users." <https://dgit.in/AvastSold>

Apple direct beaming

Apple has been on a hiring spree, building a team consisting of about a dozen engineers who have experience in the domains of aerospace, satellite and antenna design. The project for which these engineers have been hired is in its early stages and analysts believe that Apple might be working on a way to transmit data directly to Apple devices without having to rely on wireless carriers. Analysts aren't



certain if Apple is working on building the entire ecosystem i.e. ground stations and satellites, or if they're simply working on the ground equipment. Facebook, SpaceX and Amazon have

already been working towards similar goals and Apple is the latest to join the party. The new engineering team is led by Michael Trela and John Fenwick, who've previously helmed Skybox, a satellite imaging company that was sold to Google in 2014. This effort to cut out the middle man shouldn't be surprising considering that Apple is doing the same with their modern division.

<https://dgit.in/AppleSat>



AMD launches Radeon RX 5500 XT

AMD has expanded its graphics family with the introduction of the budget oriented RX 5500 XT graphics cards which are set to compete against the likes of NVIDIA's GTX 1650 Super. Pricing for the new RX 5500 XT 4 GB SKU starts at ₹12,990 (excl GST).

<https://dgit.in/RX5500XT>



NYT uses deanonymised data to track US President

The New York Times used an anonymised dataset of location pings which allowed them to track the whereabouts of one of President Trump's security detail officers. All of this was done under 2 minutes.

<https://dgit.in/WeSeeYou>



Fake account network shut by FB and Twitter

Facebook and Twitter recently shut down a network of fake accounts with display pictures that were AI-generated and made to appear American. These accounts were linked to the Epoch Media Group by Facebook.

<https://dgit.in/FBFakeAI>